

Daily AI, Crypto & Tech Power Briefing

July 11, 2026

AI Faces a Social Backlash as Crypto Searches for Better Digital Cash

July 11 was a weekend issue, so the news flow was quieter than a normal trading day. The important stories were not about one big product launch. They were about public trust, jobs, regulation and whether crypto can move beyond pure speculation.

The AI story is getting more political: protesters in San Francisco targeted OpenAI, Anthropic and Google DeepMind, while Le Monde described a younger Silicon Valley generation anxious about jobs and AI-driven restructuring. In crypto, Nouriel Roubini's new token idea shows how stablecoins are becoming a serious financial design question.

1. AI protests are moving from online debate into the street

San Francisco Chronicle · July 11, 2026

S.F. protesters march on OpenAI, Anthropic and Google DeepMind to demand: 'Stop the AI race'

The story

The San Francisco Chronicle reports that about 200 protesters marched from OpenAI to Anthropic and Google DeepMind, demanding that major AI companies pause the training of more powerful frontier models. The protest was organized by Stop the AI Race, led by former AI researcher Michael Trazzi.

The protesters linked AI to job losses, housing pressure, environmental damage and broader safety risks. Some participants work in AI or study AI safety, which makes the

protest more than a simple anti-tech event. It shows that even people close to the industry are worried about speed, control and accountability.

Why it matters

This matters because AI policy pressure is no longer only coming from Washington or Brussels. It is also coming from local communities, students and workers in the cities where AI companies operate.

For AI labs, the risk is reputational and political. If public trust weakens, regulators may feel more pressure to limit frontier model training, require safety audits or impose local rules on data centers and office expansion.

What to watch

- Whether U.S. lawmakers use public protests as evidence that AI needs stronger regulation.
 - Whether AI companies respond with more transparency around model training, safety testing and energy use.
 - Whether local pressure in San Francisco spreads to other AI hubs such as London, Seattle and New York.
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2. Silicon Valley is learning that AI disruption also hits tech workers

Le Monde · July 11, 2026

Silicon Valley's next generation feels the AI blues

The story

Le Monde describes a Silicon Valley that is excited by AI but also deeply anxious. Recent graduates worry that entry-level jobs are disappearing, while large tech companies are cutting staff and still paying huge sums for elite AI talent.

The article's strongest business point is ROI anxiety. Managers know they need to adopt AI, but many are not sure how to measure the return. That creates pressure inside companies: teams are asked to use AI to become more productive, even when workers fear the same tools may replace them.

Why it matters

This is a key shift in the AI story. For years, tech workers were seen as the winners of automation. Now AI is starting to pressure the software, consulting and product jobs that used to look safe.

Policy makers will care because job displacement can quickly become a political issue. If younger workers feel that AI makes education less valuable, governments may face pressure to regulate AI deployment, fund retraining or protect entry-level jobs.

What to watch

- Whether entry-level hiring in software and product roles keeps weakening.
- Whether companies publish clearer numbers on AI productivity instead of vague efficiency claims.
- Whether AI anxiety becomes part of U.S. and European election debates.

3. A crypto skeptic is launching a token because stablecoins are becoming real infrastructure

Business Insider · July 11, 2026

Crypto skeptic Nouriel Roubini is dipping his toe into the market, but he still says 90% of digital assets are useless

The story

Business Insider reports that economist Nouriel Roubini, one of crypto's best-known critics, is launching what he calls a stablecoin alternative. The token is linked to the Atlas Americas Fund, which holds short-term Treasurys, gold, real-estate investment trusts, agricultural commodities and defense stocks.

Roubini's argument is that traditional fiat-pegged stablecoins still lose real value when inflation is high because they usually do not pay meaningful income to holders. His token is designed as an interest-bearing, dollar-based place for people or AI agents to park money between transactions.

Why it matters

This is important because it separates blockchain infrastructure from speculative coins. Roubini still thinks most crypto assets are useless, but he also accepts that tokenized payment and settlement products may have practical value if they are backed by real assets.

Regulators will care because this kind of product sits between ETFs, stablecoins and money-market funds. The harder question is whether it should be regulated like a fund, a payment token, a stablecoin or some hybrid product.

What to watch

- Whether the token attracts real institutional users or remains a niche product.
 - Whether more stablecoin products start offering yield or inflation protection.
 - Whether regulators in the U.S., UAE and Europe clarify rules for tokenized funds and interest-bearing stablecoin alternatives.
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Useful terms

frontier model - 前沿模型	training run - 模型训练运行
AI safety - AI 安全	public trust - 公众信任
reputational risk - 声誉风险	regulatory pressure - 监管压力
local backlash - 地方反弹 / 本地反对情绪	entry-level jobs - 入门级岗位
job displacement - 岗位替代	return on investment - 投资回报率
productivity gains - 生产率提升	workforce restructuring - 劳动力重组
stablecoin alternative - 稳定币替代方案	fiat-pegged stablecoin - 法币锚定稳定币
interest-bearing token - 付息型代币	tokenized fund - 代币化基金
real assets - 实物资产 / 真实资产	reserve asset - 储备资产
settlement product - 结算产品	regulatory perimeter - 监管边界
hybrid product - 混合型产品	institutional users - 机构用户

Today's big picture

The big picture for July 11 is that AI and crypto are both being forced to prove social usefulness. AI companies must show that speed and power do not come at the cost of jobs, safety and public trust.

Crypto has a similar problem in finance. The market is moving away from slogans and toward products that look more like regulated payment, settlement and reserve infrastructure.